REVIT TEMPLATE CHECKLIST

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The best thing about Revit templates is how much time they can save you. The worst thing about Revit templates is how much time they take to create.

It's a bit of a catch-22. In order to save time, you need to spend time.

That's where the C-B-T method comes in.

The C-B-T Method for Building Revit Templates

C-B-T stands for Chassis - Body - Trim. It's a modular approach to building high-performance Revit templates.

"Wait a minute", you're thinking. "Aren't those parts of a car?"

Exactly. We're going to approach building a Revit template the same way cars are designed and built. Car manufacturers need to be super-efficient. They design something then re-use it in multiple ways.

Using the C-B-T method, you start with a general template, the Chassis, and build off it to create a variety of project-type Body templates. When starting a project, you select the appropriate Body template and then add the project specific Trim elements.

The following sections describe the parts of the C-B-T method in detail.

1. Chassis

The elements in your chassis template are your office standards. These elements will not change from project type to project type. These elements include:

- ❒ Line Styles
- ❒ Line Weights
- ❒ Line Patterns
- ❒ Text Styles
- ❒ Dimension Styles
- ❒ Browser Organization Types
- ❒ Title Blocks
- ❒ Parameters (specific to Chassis content only)
- ❒ Keynotes
- ❒ DWG Export Settings
- ❒ DWG Import Settings
- ❒ Units
- ❒ File Locations
- ❒ Fill Patterns
- ❒ Fill Types
- ❒ Materials
- ❒ View Tags
- ❒ Arrowheads
- ❒ Tags
- ❒ Annotation Symbols
- ❒ Document Macros
- ❒ Template Version View

If you need to use multiple standards in your office, create a chassis template for each standard. Be sure to use a specific naming convention for your chassis template. I like to designate mine with a numerical sequence. My office standard chassis template is "00-00". I have another GSA specific template that is named "01-00". Another template I use for Revit macros is numbered "02-00".

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2. Body

Body templates build off the chassis template. They include all the project type or discipline specific elements. If your firm works on a variety of project types, you should create a body template for each type. Likewise, if your firm is multi-discipline, you should create a body template for each discipline. Body templates should include the following elements:

- ❒ Typical Sheets
- ❒ Typical Views
- ❒ Typical Levels
- ❒ Wall Types
- ❒ Roof Types
- ❒ Floor Types
- ❒ Parameters
- ❒ Schedule Keys
- ❒ Schedules
- ❒ Legends
- ❒ Site Settings
- ❒ Parameters (specific to Body content only)
- ❒ View Templates
- ❒ Object Styles
- ❒ Phases
- ❒ Color Fill Schemes
- ❒ Filters
- ❒ Sync View

Body templates should follow a similar naming convention to the chassis template. I name mine using the number of the chassis template it's based on followed by a unique number. My single family residential template, which is based on my office standard chassis, is numbered "00-01".
My commercial template is "00-02".

3. Trim

Trim is the last step in building your template. This step focuses on adding the project-specific elements. These include file-based families, standard details, and parameters.

I recommend adding these elements directly to the project file, rather than creating another template. Why not include these in the body template? The idea behind the C-B-T method is to create light-weight and modular templates. Updating file-based families in a template can be tedious. Instead, use a tool like the Batch Family Loader to batch load families into your project file. The elements to include in the trim stage are:

- ❒ File-based Families
- ❒ Standard Details
- ❒ Project-Specific Title Blocks
- ❒ Project-Specific Parameters

Your Revit Template

A well-conceived Revit template can save you a lot of time. Though they take some time to create, templates let you leverage this investment again and again.

The C-B-T method gives you the flexibility to create high-performance Revit templates. By using a modular approach, you can more easily update your templates and create new ones as needed. Likewise, each template can be customized to meet project-specific requirements.

Get started on your templates today!